Who should I vote for? The voice note

What I think about the 2026 Israeli election, in my own words. Recorded 26 October 2026, 42 minutes.

Daniel Rosehill · Jerusalem
Election to the 26th Knesset, 27 October 2026

Prepared with Claude Opus 5.5 (Anthropic)
github.com/danielrosehill/Israel-Election-2026-Vote-Decision

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STAGE 1 · THE VOICE NOTE

What I said

I recorded the note on 26 October 2026, looking out at the Knesset building. The full transcript, with only the disfluencies removed, is **Appendix A**. These are the lines the rubric was built on (times refer to the original recording).

“There's one rotten root to it, which is that in the way this country is set up, our electoral system, there is no accountability baked into the system.”

03:26
A6 accountability

“Hopefully Netanyahu will not be elected. That's the one person I'm for sure not voting for.”

06:48
B3 Netanyahu

“The biggest issue in my life, and it's not even close, is an issue that last time I checked, not a single major party running in this election had bothered to articulate any serious policy for. And that is tenant protection law.”

07:25
A1 tenant protection

“The cost of living and the rest of it is such that getting on the property ladder is near impossible.”

15:03
A2 housing

“Do I think that the Haredim, the ultra-religious, should serve in the army? Yes. I think the social contract can't exist like this.”

19:33
B1 Haredi enlistment

“The cost of living. No one seems to be doing anything about it … Everything here is overpriced.”

22:22
A3 cost of living

“I think the best answer to antisemitism and anti-Israelism is to make Israel great.”

34:56
A5 reputation · B9

“This is our programme. It's free, it's consultative, it's democratic. We welcome participation. We're here to serve you.”

41:25
the party I'm looking for

TRANSCRIPT, DISFLUENCIES REMOVED

Appendix A · The voice note

My exact words and order from the 26 October 2026 recording, with only fillers, stutters and immediate repeats removed and known mishearings corrected. Times refer to the original 42-minute recording. The raw AssemblyAI transcript and a more heavily edited, sectioned version are in the repository.

00:00 Okay, so today is 26th October 2026, the day before the elections in Israel. And I, like many people in Israel, feel very disillusioned, disenfranchised with the entire political system. But I turn to you Claude, in order to create a guide tailored to my own voting what I'm looking for in a party, as it were. So I'll set out in this voice note which will be in a public repository. Which is intentional, in case you're asking.

00:39 So we'll do our usual process of sending this audio file for transcription, then getting a cleaned up version and please keep the audio file, the binary in the repo and just link to it in the readme in case anyone wants to actually hear the original for chain of custody. This is just if. No, can't think of any reason why.

00:58 But it's a demonstration, I guess, of a voice to research workflow that I do a lot in which I'll use a voice note to record a lengthy research brief and get all the details in and then I'll send Claude off to do his Claude like thing. And then usually I'll try, I'll pair that with some kind of an output skill which I typically tend to use Typst. I keep thinking I'm pronouncing it wrong.

01:26 The typesetting program, which is just fantastic tool. So I'll usually then round out the skill by saying, Claude, summarize your research in a PDF, bake it into a PDF, put it to my Google Drive, send it to me by email. And that's kind of the life cycle of a research repository. Sometimes once off, sometimes it's a recurrence space. So this one is just a public demo and sometimes I'll generate a podcast from it.

01:54 So this one, I might also create a podcast episode too, as sometimes I prefer to listen to what Claude finds, or both. They're complementary. Okay, so here is basically my feelings on the current state of affairs in Israel.

02:14 So my long standing critique of Israeli politics is. And I'm recording this actually looking at the Israeli Parliament building from outside of a window here. Not metaphorically speaking, literally. I can see it from where I'm recording this and when I look upon it, I feel this feeling of disgust that rises from an institution that has become so far divorced from any mandate of serving citizens, that it's unimaginable that this house is a farce, it's not representing the interests of the Israeli Electorate. It's a collection of self important people infighting, people abusing the name of the Knesset, the institution in ancient Israel and some of the manifestations of it, the 120 seats and it's a slight on the old institution.

03:14 It's a Knesset of, it's a [unclear: "sugbet"] Knesset, whatever you want to call it.

03:26 And in the litany of things that I feel is broken and wrong with Israeli politics, I feel it stems from one very fundamental. There's one rotten root to it which is that in the way this country is set up, our electoral system here there is no accountability baked into the system and we have an electorate that accepts this because this is the way things are here and Israelis are at once. Is my external critique as someone who moved here from Ireland at once very worldly and sometimes also peculiar. Peculiarly. I'm having a hard time with some words today in a peculiar way insular in the sense that this is their frame of reference and this is how politics are done here.

04:17 And my frame of reference, having grown up in Ireland, which has its own pros and cons about its political system, but at least one of the good things you can say about it is that because you have a politician you vote for at the national elections for an electoral area and there is theoretically someone you can complain to or contact to get representation and we have this completely broken political system here in which there is, because of the design of the political system, we have incentivized an extremely fractured and divisive political system that is characterized by repetitive breakaway alliances that are splitting votes and which are often less often created in order to create genuinely interesting ideological propositions and coherent platforms and more often because some person didn't get the slate that they thought that was becoming to them and therefore they decided I'm going to form a breakaway party or the party exists because one of its core principles is we will not be in government with this party. And the commonality here is that none of these expressions articulate anything about what this party is going to do for the electorate or the people. That's the fundamental problem as I see it, with Israeli politics. So I've been kind of reading naturally about who's running in this upcoming election and trying to even summon up the

motivation to do that because it's exhausting. What there's like three more political parties, four more, five more from the last time.

06:19 Why? Who? And the first question you'd ask about any of them is, well, what do they stand for that's going to actually benefit my life. And all you read about in the news has nothing to do with that. The political system that we have here in Israel creates because the Israeli electorate is itself so divided in this system.

06:48 The only way to. The way in which parties differentiate themselves is by differentiating upon the slice of the electorate that they pander to instead of collective issues. And the reason I feel so profoundly disillusioned about the political situation in Israel is that I could say, okay, well, hopefully Netanyahu will not be elected. That's the one person I'm for sure not voting for. When people say, well, what about Eisenkot, what about this party, that party?

07:25 I say, it's the same problem. That's what. That's where I will be even more pessimistic than some people here because I'll say, yeah, it's more of the same. Can't you see that there parties who are saying we will, we demand that the Haredim draft exemption will end the judicial reform and the issues that matter to me in my 10 years living in the state of Israel as an immigrant who moved here from Ireland, by the greatest detrimental thing or the biggest issue in my life, and it's not even close, is an issue that last time I checked, not a single major party running in this election had bothered to articulate any serious policy for. And that is tenant protection law.

08:21 I spent the majority of June, July, it's all a blur this summer, basically self moving an apartment. And we did that because our previous landlord, we had a leak, woke up one day to find that there was water dripping on my bed. And when I asked after two weeks, we told the landlord on the day when I said, so are you gonna fix it? He came the next day and then sent us this. It was very pleasant.

08:56 Of course I'm gonna get a fix. I'm gonna get right on it. And then followed up the next day with an extremely angry, I couldn't believe [unclear: "state the apart"] and basically retaliatory termination of the lease. And we had, our son is now 15 months old. The time was much younger.

09:16 We were sleeping as a family on the couch because our room, it got to the point where there was mold growing on the roof. I was sending the landlord video updates being like, for your sake, not mine, you probably want to get on this asap because your place is being ruined. I got. Literally did everything in my power to

09:40 make it happen. And it's something that the law says they have three days to do it. And of course, he just didn't do it, because what's the point of having a law if there is absolutely no consequence to it?

09:53 And if people. What's the point of having a law if people are. The lesson that. The chilling effect of my story that reverberates out through our friends and through my colleagues and the rest is that don't dare exercise even the minimal laws you.

10:10 The rights you have, because the landlord will just decide not to renew your lease. And because we have tenancy at will, he can say, yeah, I just decided not to. Even though this was a very clear example of a retaliatory lease, it made absolutely no difference. And we found this turned into a.

10:28 But this is the hot issue that gets me hot under the collar. We consulted with a lawyer, and he was very unpleasant. We couldn't fix. We asked to.

10:37 Even we were trying to explain to the man that we need. He's like, yeah, just okay, if you don't want to stay here, just leave. And we're like, okay, but you do realize that we need a roof over our heads. I don't know if that point was lost in translation there, Mr. Landlord.

10:56 So when we went to our lawyer, we kind of got the same reaction. And we're both like, my wife and I, okay, we're just going to tell you what finding a place to live in Jerusalem is like at the moment. It means you go for viewings after viewing, after viewing, you have to firstly pay an illegal agency. Because every single agent has cornered the market in basically a scam that frustrated the previous attempt at creating tenancy law.

11:26 It's an illegal thing that they found this ridiculous workaround for, and de facto you have to pay it. That's one month's rent plus VAT to the agent fee. So when you find a new place, if you find a new place, you're looking at your weekend spent trudging around with a young baby. Neither of us have family in Israel.

11:49 Going in, in the heat of the summer to see the depressing places. We even found that some of the listings, this was the kind of pinnacle of it.

12:00 They began new trends, started saying this image on listings you'd see, image was enhanced with artificial intelligence. So you're like, wait, okay, so this is an AI image of the place that you're posting. And the last move was astronomically expensive. You have to disconnect all the utilities from the landlord's name because the local municipality in Jerusalem, in all its infinite wisdom, with which it exerts itself digging up the city and making this place chaos, has not actually come up with any workable system for tenants to

pay their Arnona, the highest one in the country, in a way that doesn't incur a yearly obligation to them on a property they don't own. So you have to literally do unpaid admin work for the landlord to get yourself and also to get yourself off the hook for paying somebody else's municipal bill plus electricity, plus water, plus the rest of it.

13:02 Then in the next place, you've the pleasure of doing all of this again. So the last time we moved, similar story. This landlord was a lot nicer, but we lost the place after paying rent every single month on time. The rest of it, because he wanted to give his apartment away to his daughters. So I can't even describe the cumulative, the mental sense of

13:31 loss of stability. A deep, a profound sort of when you don't feel like you have a place and we're working, we're putting, we're saving. Where my wife's an architect, I work in tech, and we're looking at the spreadsheets and we're like, A, it doesn't really matter because the numbers just don't seem to check out that we can do this. And B, even if it did, even if we were doing everything in our power to get on the property ladder and the rest of it and living off beans and rice, I don't think we'd have anything to show for it because every time we do this, the last move was 10,000 shekels. The next move was 10,000 shekels time off work.

14:14 This one, I literally moved half our boxes ourselves. So if you're listening, if anyone ever listens to this or reads a transcript and you're hearing a man rant for 10 minutes about how I spent my summer trying to parent a toddler while moving boxes to do as much of the move as I could, because between all these expenses and deposits and agent fees, we literally, to ensure cash flow, had to have a cheap move. That's when I look around and say, how is the state? This is just, that's the biggest setback to

14:51 for me, the Jewish vision of every Jewish person moving to Israel and having a place to live here and prospering. I'm like, yeah, but we.

15:03 The cost of living and the rest of it is such that getting on their property ladder is near impossible.

15:12 I can't. If I had literally, if my hourly rate were multiplied by the amount of hours that I spent tearing up ethernet cables in a previous rental, but to put them back down in the next one, packing boxes, unpacking boxes, moving boxes, finding place for things, starting unboxing. To do that with a family, I would be. My bank account would be in a much better state than it was now. Put it like that.

15:42 So that's been. Mentally, spiritually, personally. The drain that is sucked so much of what's good about this country and turned it into frustration and anger and cynicism. It's that other things, honestly, not so much. I actually enjoy living here.

16:02 The people are great. I love the food. I adapt to the culture. The tech is amazing. There's so much that's good here.

16:12 The bad thing, religious extremism, I find in Jerusalem, I don't like that it's becoming coercive. I'm not a fan of Jerusalem, to put it mildly these days at least. Or I'm very. Let's say I'm less optimistic about the city than I ever have been or more pessimistic. But that issue as well is just.

16:35 It's like a case study in how to mismanage a city. What's happening at the moment, an endless creation. It's sheer greed. It's absolutely. It's catastrophic.

16:49 The city is basically just digging up left, right and center to create this enormous glut of high rises, turning a blind eye to the fact that half of them are just for investment properties or people who won't live here, while people actually living in the city are literally watching these out of place big skyscrapers going up that they won't be able to afford to live in. And no one's even bothering to [unclear: "post a road change"]. And we're like, this city is a joke. Seriously,

17:16 who's actually. You read about the cable car going to the old city. You're like, that was the front news today on the Times of Israel. And you're like, who's calling the shots in this place?

17:29 Because they do not have their heads screwed on. The city needs the poorest city in Israel, this place needs jobs, incentives for creating jobs. We don't need luxury housing, crazy investment properties. We need coherent, accessible, affordable housing. And you can't just plonk people in housing without creating at least some basic scaffolding for an economy here.

17:54 And you look at the resources the city puts into that and it's atrocious, it's minimal. I don't blame any VC or investor from not really being so hot on the Jerusalem pitch. A city best known these days for religious extremism and riots and. Yeah, no, I don't like anyway, so that, despite all that negativity, I think Jerusalem is the capital of the Jewish world and the city deserves so much better than this and should be such a more inclusive, affordable and accessible place in this. And I use all those adjectives together.

18:33 So the anger comes from my feeling that this is just a microcosm of what's gone wrong in this country, that something nice about it. The good things about the city, about Jerusalem, the slower pace of life

compared to Tel Aviv, the fact that people are a bit less maybe so stylish. I like that. I really like that. Actually, I'm not a very ostentatious person.

18:59 But when that gets, what's happening now, the stagnation of the long term residents in the city center and this artificial glut of construction for people who will parachute in here for a few weeks a year, don't speak Hebrew, don't want to interact with people, what kind of a recipe for coherence in a city, in a capital city is that? It's a disaster. So where was I? Where should I pick up this rant?

19:33 So when I look at the, what everyone's jockeying over, do I think that the Haredim, the ultra religious, should serve in the army? Yes.

19:46 I think the social contract can't exist like this. You can't have an internal state within a state. You have to have some basic commonality within the state that the rule of law is the rule of law and you don't get benefits if you don't contribute. So many people, I can say from our own experience as well, there's no. If you're a struggling young family working and being beaten down by agent fees and slumlords and all the stuff we can talk about from personal experience ad nauseam, there is essentially no help.

20:28 When the war with Iran broke out, I feel like the. I was kind of in disbelief. That was long. That was a long war. The one earlier this year was it five weeks.

20:41 And you wake up one day, a siren goes off at three in the morning or whatever time it started. And you're like, oh crap. What's going on? And then I'm kind of a prepper or have become a prepper. You're like, well, everything's planned, right?

20:57 The shelters are open and they're not. And at the time, in our old place, like many buildings, we did not have a public shelter. And it's a litany of, there's no map, there's no interactive map. When war broke out, they weren't open.

21:18 I contributed a router to a shelter that got stolen. We got a parking ticket after the last war. That was crazy. After the ceasefire, the shelter was a car park, literally.

21:30 City run shelter was the designated. Sorry, city run car park was a designated shelter, deep shelter. And ceasefire was announced and we were charged for I think an hour or two of parking, exit fee. And you're like, what? For sheltering an emergency?

21:52 Are you serious? So it's just things like this. I'm like, what has this state become? How did we go from this collectivist, idealistic poor, but wholesome society to this thing? Because this is not a.

22:08 These dynamics are just, they're bigger than any one thing. These are just the little things that I notice. But so okay, to be more coherent. What things affect me in my personal life day to day.

22:22 The cost of living. No one seems to be doing anything about it. The fact that they had this tax exemption for AliExpress. How petty can you be? Everything here is overpriced.

22:31 It's always been overpriced. The competition, it's anti competitive. And some guy, Bezalel Smotrich, the right wing guy, introduces, raises the limit and they put it back. You're like, what a miserable government. This is literally, come on.

22:46 That's how. AliExpress is the escape valve for the Israeli economy. I'm convinced. You realize everyone is buying. Go on to AliExpress listing in any listing and you're seeing Israeli flags.

23:02 You're like, wait, is this everyone buying everything from this? And you ask your friends and you're like, oh yeah, that's so, we're all doing this because everything here, it costs double or triple what it does abroad. And it's. And there's no warranty. Or when you try to get your warranty, there's no warranty service.

23:19 It's all this dysfunctionalism. When I go to the US or visit the US with my in laws, I appreciate that they have so many internal divisions and debates in the US but the biggest thing that's a breath of fresh air when I visit the US is the feeling that there is a basic level of dysfunction. There's a basic level of dysfunction here that just feels gratuitous. You're like, it does not need to be this way.

23:46 Life does. It's like you're trying to make life hard. It's like the delivery driver who gets irate. A bad example.

23:57 But whether it's the bureaucracy for small business, it just feels like when that layer is removed, you're like, oh, well, stuff, actually. Oh, this is pretty nice. Other things I noticed recently. So our son, we had to go to ER twice in the course of the last month. We had a pretty rough month.

24:17 Our son just started. His began well a couple of months ago. So I have asthma, and I have very vivid memories of having an asthma attack as a kid. So Ezra comes down with the cold. We come down with the cold.

24:30 We're all there, miserable in bed, and suddenly he's really, really having a hard time breathing, right? So we're like, oh, this is pretty scary. We bring him to the doctor. The doctor says, this is our health fund. Prescribes Ventolin nebulizer.

24:46 We're like, okay, great. So we get that, we do it. And in middle of the night, we're like, this is not working. He's getting worse. You can see his neck.

24:55 He's pulling his neck. We're like, okay, this is, I don't feel good just staying here. So we call our health fund Maccabi.

25:10 And basically, I can't remember the first time we went to Terem. I don't think they answered. So by the time we got to urgent care, there's no, the helpline says it's not emergency response.

25:30 And the second time, which was more recently, was just much, much. That was terrible. So we went there to this urgent care place, which I won't name, which. Same story, same pattern exactly. And they say, his oxygen is a bit low.

25:45 We need to give him oxygen. We go into the room and we're just left there 20, 30 minutes, he throws up, nobody comes. And we're trying to, there's no one working there. And my wife and I are like, what do we do? It's supposed to just wait here, like they've just told us.

26:05 And he was refusing oxygen, he wouldn't put it up to his face. So we went to the ER. They were great. And we met another family there who had the exact same situation. They were like, yeah, we just don't go there anymore.

26:21 So the healthcare system, the vaunted healthcare system, which I appreciate in large areas is good, that's a problem. So I read about judicial reform. I read about whether Netanyahu is suitable to stay in government because of the corruption allegations about a few cigars. And I say the first thing sometimes, this is, everyone says this, but there was a time, if I said this before, it wasn't with conviction. Now I can say with conviction.

26:52 I'm not a Netanyahu fan at all. I really believe he's, I think, whatever, I don't think it's constructive. And that's my issue with Israeli politics. You can just say it's become obsessed with the minutiae of his rule and these issues about the Haredim draft, the judicial reform.

27:19 Before we create 10 splinter parties and we debate these grand issues in a country without a constitution.

27:33 I just wonder every single time how is it that we have a political system whereby electoral cycle after electoral cycle, parties can basically stand up with essentially no platform, coherent platform policy, platform research backed platform targeting the burning issues, OECD math scores. There's a list of them. And instead we see it as, well, we're going to create a new party that's going to be anti Haredim. This one's going to be pro Haredim. This one's going to be a mixture.

28:07 And I think it's across the board.

28:18 The fact that it's accepted by the people who will vote for these parties and that there's so much fractionalism and self interest that they can't learn the lessons of what happened to the destruction of the left and see that in their rush to create new splinter parties, they're splitting the vote and harming the collective interest. But no one, including the voters. And the organizers say, the October 7th Commission of Inquiry fault finding bring. Okay, that was horrific. It was a tragedy.

28:49 It was horrible. Of course there should be a State commission of inquiry. But is that the most important? That's not a policy. That shouldn't be frontline policy.

29:01 We're for state commission of inquiry into October 7th. That's a security, two potentially I think useful reasons for that. One, security review, improve, learn lessons and improve. That's a task for the security bodies. Two, culpability.

29:18 So there has to be punishments. And if that can, if that doesn't exist, then there's a more fundamental issue. But an independent commission, I just don't understand what that is supposed to achieve or do for the benefit of this whole state and this whole country. It seems like a very strange reaction to this horrible attack that this is going to eclipse everything else because the Israel I see that's tearing itself asunder, that's dog eat dog where people, young people who move here, make aliyah to come to Israel can be kicked out of a apartment because there's a property boom and the landlord decides he wants to cash in and they're on the pavement and the state and say there's. That's just the way it is.

30:11 I feel like those are more important issues that, those fixes would be more widely beneficial than any. The results of any state inquiry into October 7th could be. So I find myself looking at the one party after the other, the old ones and the jaded pattern of ex generals and I just see, creating their own party, just see another iteration of the exact same problem. The root, the rotten root, the total lack of, the lack of a political system that views the electorate is there to represent people that big issues, policy related to security, questions of national identity need national consensus in a constitution and in the tradition of democracy I grew up in, a referendum. Those can be those big issues, of course important and they are of course going to delineate between parties.

31:17 But there is a complete and utter lack of focus on the bread and butter, to use that really trite analogy. And the Israel that I like personally is an Israel where hard working people can do well, can afford to have a good life here to vacation in Israel without it being four times the cost of a cheap getaway in Europe. And of course the national issues. Israel's reputation is in the gutter because we have a, whatever this rotten system of government is that requires a extremist racist like Ben-Gvir and Smotrich and the others to hold this together.

32:09 It's just, it's hard to articulate, which is why I'm probably gonna have to cut some audio here at this part of the note. But I hope this explains where I feel what I care about personally. What I want to see is an Israel that is strong, that forms alliances where possible.

32:32 The Palestinian question, I will just say that I don't rule out a Palestinian state as a principle. I just don't see any way that it can be done and any, I don't think that's what's holding everything back.

32:55 I think that Israel's reaction to October 7th has created enormous and I think honestly largely justified international rage and disgust and the government has done nothing to. All we do is just fund more hasbara. Let's fire some more propaganda. And the world is tired of it. And Netanyahu comes out with, after telling us that Iran's being contained like he did last summer, suddenly retweeting an image of a bomb over Tel Aviv.

33:25 So we're like what kind of integrity is that? What kind of leaders, how low have we sunk from the days of wholesome people like Ben Gurion that this is just what passes other people in the Likud actually see it for that or just kind of laugh and say well that's just electioneering but it's a dismal place to have sunk. So I want an Israel where the people who thoughtful people not doesn't have to be technocrats but committed people furthering their collective good, peace and prosperity and focusing on Israel for once. Everything seems to be externalized for some reason. That's what I've noticed where the world, the global reputation is tanking and we're focused on building bridges with the Jewish Diaspora.

34:24 My long term philosophy here, contrarian again is that should not be in scope. If Israel's fighting the view that the Jewish people and Israel are different things. And I agree there's a portion of world Jewry who aren't Zionist then if you say on the other hand, well we're appointing ourselves the global protector and represent and guardian of world Jews. You've just created that conflation so you can't then turn around and say you've. I think it's unfair frankly.

34:56 And I don't think in a country with the kind of health care that exists at least in parts here, we should be doing that. Israel was founded in 1948. If Jewish communities abroad aren't interested in moving here, I would say why should we maintain this apparatus for these other big tranches of public waste, the efforts to combat anti Semitism, the efforts for public diplomacy that never really show fruit and create this national obsession with how the world sees us that is kind of almost glaringly, I just don't think serves any good. I think the best answer to anti Semitism and anti Israelism is to make Israel great. And I don't believe that everything, you can't criticism, you can't create a world where everyone likes you.

36:05 And we've just see so many good things here and also so many challenges I think are we've got a full caseload of stuff to work on in this country and building up this country and making this country what it should be. And we've got basically a waste of time, political leadership, political class that's asleep at the wheel. I think the economy and country is driven by the talent and skill of everyone else, including the army for that matter. And I think the politicians are just what they are. And we need a radically reformed political system, radical improvement in transparency, programs for government that are coherent.

36:56 And the meta thing is a move away from issues of. Because there'll always be these issues for people to, for parties to argue about the political, the security situation, if that never changes. But that's all we view as whether we're coming from the left or the right, that that's what it's legitimate for a party to articulate policy about. Then we'll never get past security. And that's what's happening.

37:20 The cottage cheese protest, the housing protest. That's ancient history in comparative terms now why is there no movement since look at the numbers. Situation's not getting better and yet we're all up in arms about judicial reform. Very dangerous, very erosive. But at least can we be consistent with the stuff we actually, if it was in proportion to what it's actually going to affect people.

37:48 I think people be on the street for that didn't talk about wealth inequality, intergenerational wealth differences in Israel. That's a huge issue. And I think a lot of the disconnect from the political class and why they're so content arguing about anything but rent is that most of the political class in Israel belong to old families who have a lot of property and like many old Israeli families have an investment stream of that's being funded by newcomers and I just think it's such a perversion of the Zionist idealist. This was not how the idea of a Jewish state where every Jewish person had a home and it could have a dignified life here, this was not.

38:35 I can't imagine that this was anything like what Herzl intended. So that's who I. That's all I can get off my chest in these 40 minutes before the election. And what I look what I like from you Claude, is I am part writer, part data, part time data nerd. So I'd like to do this systematically.

38:58 You can take that lump of thought that I provided and give some coherence to it. And then I'd like to I've already created a data set for the parties on Hugging Face the lists, who's on the list and I'd like you to give me a. Let's do it like this. Let's define a objective rubric for judging the parties according to the issues that I assign priority to and where I stand on those. Then one by one let's review each party, let's give them a score and then let's stratify this analysis based upon alignment with what I would call my socioeconomic and non divisive, none, not, let's put security, nation states, Haredi enlistment, let's put those in to one side for the moment let's call that stream B issues and stream A issues are the less contentious things I see as the everyday pain points facing Israeli citizens and I've given just a few examples rent, housing instability, cost of living, bureaucracy and I would actually put in Israel's global reputation in that because on the one hand it's a meta issue, on the other it's one that trickles.

40:18 Everyone bears that in some way or another I believe.

40:26 Let's call those A and I'd like to firstly rank the parties from most best match to lowest match just on that axis and then on both axis so split 2 will be alignment together and then you can give me a analysis with the summary of the party's positions and I will say as one meta guide, one high level guide to what I'm looking for is really my [unclear: "David Fiducia"] party the mission we're here not because we demand a commission of inquiry for October 7th because we say the Haredim must serve that language, whether I agree with it or not, immediately alienates me because I say it's the same next version of the same story. The last 10 elections, 2026 edition. We're here because we can see that the state of Israel. We're here.

41:25 I didn't even mention Iran, but put security in [unclear: "In Tron, whatever it was. Tron"]. And this is our program. It's free, it's consultative, it's democratic.

41:36 We welcome participation. We're here to serve you. And this is how we think. This is how we propose to do it.

41:45 Cards on the table. Manifestations of that, literally, the bar is so incredibly low that you're like, well, if they had a PDF on their website for a certain area policy translated into all commonly spoken languages in Israel, even I think that would be a hard bar to pass. But that would be a very favorable indication.

42:08 That's it. That's today's research task. And maybe good, I recorded that so I can get my public journal about my thoughts on what's. What I'm finding frustrating about the political cycle in Israel and just where we are as a country at the moment. Onto this notepad.

FALSE STARTS AND REPETITION REMOVED, SECTIONED

Edited transcript

Politics voice note: edited transcript

Light edit of Daniel's voice note: his words in the first person, every point kept, with false starts, repetition and abandoned clauses removed and grammar fixed only where needed for readability. Section headings are added; the time in brackets is where each section starts in the audio.

Recorded: 2026-10-26 (the day before the 27 October 2026 Knesset election)

Sources: raw transcript · disfluencies removed

Why this note exists (00:00)

Okay, so today is 26th October 2026, the day before the elections in Israel. Like many people in Israel, I feel very disillusioned and disenfranchised with the entire political system. So I'm turning to you, Claude, to create a guide tailored to my own vote: what I'm looking for in a party, as it were. I'll set it out in this voice note, which will be in a public repository. That's intentional, in case you're asking.

We'll do our usual process: send this audio file for transcription, then get a cleaned-up version. Please keep the audio file, the binary, in the repo and link to it in the README, in case anyone wants to hear the original for chain of custody. Not that I can think of any reason why.

It's a demonstration, I guess, of a voice-to-research workflow that I use a lot. I use a voice note to record a lengthy research brief and get all the details in, and then I send Claude off to do his Claude-like thing. Usually I pair that with some kind of output skill, which typically uses Typst (I keep thinking I'm pronouncing it wrong), the typesetting program, which is just a fantastic tool. So I'll usually round out the skill by saying: Claude, summarise your research, bake it into a PDF, put it in my Google Drive, send it to me by email. That's the life cycle of a research repository. Sometimes it's a one-off, sometimes it's recurring. This one is just a public demo.

Sometimes I'll generate a podcast from it, and I might create a podcast episode from this one too, as sometimes I prefer to listen to what Claude finds. Or both; they're complementary.

Okay, so here are basically my feelings on the current state of affairs in Israel.

The Knesset and the electoral system: no accountability (02:14)

I'm recording this looking at the Israeli parliament building from a window here. Not metaphorically: literally. I can see it from where I'm recording, and when I look at it I feel disgust rising at an institution that has become so far divorced from any mandate of serving citizens. This house is a farce. It's not representing the interests of the Israeli electorate. It's a collection of self-important people infighting, people abusing the name of the Knesset, the institution in ancient Israel and some of its manifestations, the 120 seats. It's a slight on the old institution. It's a [unclear: "sugbet"] Knesset, whatever you want to call it.

My long-standing critique of Israeli politics is that the whole litany of things I feel is broken and wrong with it stems from one rotten root: in the way this country is set up, in our electoral system here, there is no accountability baked into the system. And we have an electorate that accepts this, because this is the way things are here. This is my external critique, as someone who moved here from Ireland: Israelis are at once very worldly and, in a peculiar way (I'm having a hard time with some words today), insular, in the sense that this is their frame of reference and this is how politics are done here.

My frame of reference is having grown up in Ireland. Its political system has its own pros and cons, but at least one of the good things you can say about it is that you vote for a politician for an electoral area at the national elections, so there is, theoretically, someone you can complain to or contact to get representation. Here we have a completely broken political system. Its design has incentivised an extremely fractured and

divisive politics, characterised by repeated breakaway alliances that split votes. Those are less often created to offer genuinely interesting ideological propositions and coherent platforms, and more often because some person didn't get the slate they thought was becoming to them, so they decided to form a breakaway party. Or the party exists because one of its core principles is "we will not be in government with this party". What they all have in common is that none of them articulates anything about what the party is going to do for the electorate, for the people. That's the fundamental problem with Israeli politics as I see it.

So naturally I've been reading about who's running in this election, and trying even to summon up the motivation to do that, because it's exhausting. There are three, four, five more political parties than last time. Why? Who? The first question you'd ask about any of them is: what do they stand for that's actually going to benefit my life? And nothing you read in the news has anything to do with that. Because the Israeli electorate is itself so divided, the way parties in this system differentiate themselves is by the slice of the electorate they pander to, instead of by collective issues.

And the reason I feel so profoundly disillusioned about the political situation is this. I could say, okay, hopefully Netanyahu won't be elected. He's the one person I'm definitely not voting for. But when people say, well, what about Eisenkot, what about this party or that party, I say it's the same problem. That's where I'm even more pessimistic than some people here, because I say: yeah, it's more of the same. Can't you see there are parties saying "we demand that the Haredi draft exemption end", or about the judicial reform?

Meanwhile, of the issues that matter to me in my ten years living in the State of Israel as an immigrant from Ireland, the most detrimental thing, the biggest issue in my life, and it's not even close, is one that, last time I checked, not a single major party running in this election had bothered to articulate any serious policy for. And that is tenant protection law.

Tenant protection and the move (08:21)

I spent most of June and July (it's all a blur this summer) basically moving apartment ourselves. We did that because of our previous landlord. We had a leak: I woke up one day to find water dripping on my bed. We told the landlord on the day. After two weeks I asked him, "So are you going to fix it?" He came the next day and then sent us a very pleasant message: of course I'm going to get it fixed, I'm going to get right on it. And the next day he followed up with an extremely angry [unclear: "I couldn't believe state the apart"] and basically retaliatory termination of the lease.

Our son is now 15 months old; at the time he was much younger. We were sleeping as a family on the couch, because it got to the point where there was mould growing on the roof of our room. I was sending the landlord video updates saying: for your sake, not mine, you probably want to get on this ASAP, because your place is being ruined. I literally did everything in my power to make it happen. The law says they have three days to do it. And of course he just didn't, because what's the point of having a law if there is absolutely no consequence to it?

What's the point of having a law if the lesson, the chilling effect of my story that reverberates out through our friends, my colleagues and the rest, is: don't dare exercise even the minimal rights you have, because the landlord will just decide not to renew your lease? Because we have tenancy at will, he can say, yeah, I just decided not to. Even though this was a very clear example of a retaliatory lease termination, it made absolutely no difference.

This is the issue that gets me hot under the collar. We consulted a lawyer, and he was very unpleasant. We couldn't fix it. We even tried to explain to the landlord that we need somewhere to live, and he's like, yeah, okay, if you don't want to stay here, just leave. And we're like, okay, but you do realise that we need a roof over our heads? I don't know if that point was lost in translation there, Mr Landlord.

When we went to our lawyer, we got kind of the same reaction. So my wife and I were both like: okay, we're just going to tell you what finding a place to live in Jerusalem is like at the moment. You go to viewing after viewing after viewing. First you have to pay an illegal agency fee, because every single agent has cornered the market in what is basically a scam, one that frustrated the previous attempt at creating tenancy law. It's illegal, they found this ridiculous workaround for it, and de facto you have to pay it: one month's rent plus VAT as the agent fee. So if you find a new place, you're looking at your weekends spent trudging around with a young baby (neither of us has family in Israel), in the heat of the summer, to see depressing places. The pinnacle of it:

a new trend started where you'd see on listings "image was enhanced with artificial intelligence". So you're like, wait, this is an AI image of the place you're posting?

And the last move was astronomically expensive. You have to disconnect all the utilities from the landlord's name, because the Jerusalem municipality, in all its infinite wisdom, with which it exerts itself digging up the city and making this place chaos, has not come up with any workable system for tenants to pay their Arnona, the highest in the country, in a way that doesn't incur a yearly obligation to them on a property they don't own. So you literally have to do unpaid admin work for the landlord, and also to get yourself off the hook for paying somebody else's municipal bill, plus electricity, plus water, plus the rest of it. Then in the next place you've the pleasure of doing all of it again.

The last time we moved before that, similar story. That landlord was a lot nicer, but we lost the place, after paying rent on time every single month, because he wanted to give his apartment to his daughters.

I can't even describe the cumulative, mental sense of loss of stability: a profound sense of not feeling like you have a place. We're working, we're saving. My wife's an architect, I work in tech, and we look at the spreadsheets and say: A, it doesn't really matter, because the numbers just don't seem to check out for us to do this. And B, even if they did, even if we did everything in our power to get on the property ladder and lived off beans and rice, I don't think we'd have anything to show for it, because of what each move costs. The last move was 10,000 shekels. The next move was 10,000 shekels, plus time off work.

This one, I literally moved half our boxes ourselves. So if anyone ever listens to this or reads a transcript and hears a man ranting for ten minutes about how he spent his summer trying to parent a toddler while moving boxes, doing as much of the move as I could because, between all these expenses, deposits and agent fees, we literally had to have a cheap move to ensure cash flow: that's when I look around and ask, how is the state…? For me, this is the biggest setback to the Jewish vision of every Jewish person moving to Israel, having a place to live here and prospering. I'm like, yeah, but the cost of living and the rest of it are such that getting on the property ladder is near impossible.

If my hourly rate were multiplied by the hours I spent tearing up ethernet cables in one rental to put them back down in the next, packing boxes, unpacking boxes, moving boxes, finding places for things, doing all that with a family, my bank account would be in a much better state than it is now. Put it like that.

So that's been the drain, mentally, spiritually, personally, that has sucked so much of what's good about this country and turned it into frustration, anger and cynicism. Other things, honestly, not so much. I actually enjoy living here. The people are great. I love the food. I've adapted to the culture. The tech is amazing. There's so much that's good here.

Jerusalem (16:12)

The bad thing is religious extremism. I find in Jerusalem that it's becoming coercive, and I don't like that. I'm not a fan of Jerusalem these days, to put it mildly; or at least, let's say, I'm less optimistic about the city than I've ever been.

That issue as well is a case study in how to mismanage a city. What's happening at the moment is an endless [unclear: "creation"; possibly "construction"]. It's sheer greed. It's catastrophic. The city is basically digging up left, right and centre to create this enormous glut of high-rises, turning a blind eye to the fact that half of them are investment properties or for people who won't live here, while the people actually living in the city literally watch these big, out-of-place skyscrapers going up that they won't be able to afford to live in. And no one's even bothering to [unclear: "post a road change"]. This city is a joke. Seriously, who's actually…? You read about the cable car going to the Old City, which was the front news today on the Times of Israel, and you're like, who's calling the shots in this place? Because they do not have their heads screwed on.

This place, the poorest city in Israel, needs jobs, incentives for creating jobs. We don't need luxury housing and crazy investment properties. We need coherent, accessible, affordable housing. And you can't just plonk people in housing without creating at least some basic scaffolding for an economy here. You look at the resources the city puts into that and it's atrocious, it's minimal. I don't blame any VC or investor for not being so hot on the Jerusalem pitch: a city best known these days for religious extremism and riots and… yeah, no. Anyway.

Despite all that negativity, I think Jerusalem is the capital of the Jewish world, the city deserves so much better than this, and it should be a far more inclusive, affordable and accessible place. And I use all those adjectives together.

So the anger comes from my feeling that this is a microcosm of what's gone wrong in this country, because there's something nice about it. The good things about Jerusalem: the slower pace of life compared to Tel Aviv, the fact that people are maybe a bit less stylish. I like that. I really like that, actually; I'm not a very ostentatious person. But what's happening now, the stagnation of the long-term residents in the city centre and this artificial glut of construction for people who will parachute in here for a few weeks a year, don't speak Hebrew and don't want to interact with people: what kind of recipe for coherence in a city, in a capital city, is that? It's a disaster.

So where was I? Where should I pick up this rant?

The Haredi draft and the social contract (19:33)

When I look at what everyone's jockeying over: do I think the Haredim, the ultra-religious, should serve in the army? Yes. I think the social contract can't exist like this. You can't have a state within a state. You have to have some basic commonality within the state: the rule of law is the rule of law, and you don't get benefits if you don't contribute. And I can say from our own experience: if you're a struggling young working family, being beaten down by agent fees and slumlords and all the stuff we could talk about from personal experience ad nauseam, there is essentially no help.

The Iran war and the shelters (20:28)

When the war with Iran broke out, I was kind of in disbelief. That was a long war, the one earlier this year; was it five weeks? You wake up one day, a siren goes off at three in the morning or whatever time it started, and you're like, oh crap, what's going on? I'm kind of a prepper, or have become one, so you think, well, everything's planned, right? The shelters are open. And they're not. At the time, in our old place, like many buildings, we did not have a public shelter. And it's a litany: there's no map, no interactive map. When the war broke out, they weren't open. I contributed a router to a shelter, and it got stolen.

And we got a parking ticket after the last war. That was crazy. The shelter was literally a car park: a city-run car park was a designated deep shelter. The ceasefire was announced and we were charged for, I think, an hour or two of parking, an exit fee. And you're like, what? For sheltering in an emergency? Are you serious?

So it's things like this. I'm like, what has this state become? How did we go from this collectivist, idealistic, poor but wholesome society to this? These dynamics are bigger than any one thing; these are just the little things I notice. But okay, to be more coherent: what affects me in my personal life, day to day?

Cost of living (22:22)

The cost of living. No one seems to be doing anything about it. Take the tax exemption for AliExpress. How petty can you be? Everything here is overpriced; it's always been overpriced. It's anti-competitive. And some guy, Bezalel Smotrich, the right-wing guy, raises the limit and they put it back. You're like, what a miserable government. Come on.

AliExpress is the escape valve for the Israeli economy, I'm convinced. Go onto any AliExpress listing and you're seeing Israeli flags, and you think, wait, is everyone buying everything from this? You ask your friends and they're like, oh yeah, we're all doing this, because everything here costs double or triple what it does abroad. And there's no warranty, or when you try to get your warranty, there's no warranty service.

It's all this dysfunctionalism. When I visit the US with my in-laws, I appreciate that they have so many internal divisions and debates there, but the biggest breath of fresh air when I visit is the feeling that there is a basic level of function. There's a basic level of dysfunction here that just feels gratuitous. It does not need to be this way. It's like you're trying to make life hard. It's like the delivery driver who gets irate (a bad example). But whether it's the bureaucracy for small business or anything else, when that layer is removed, you're like, oh, well, stuff actually... oh, this is pretty nice.

Healthcare (24:05)

Other things I've noticed recently: we had to take our son to the ER twice in the last month. We had a pretty rough month. [unclear: "Our son just started. His began well a couple of months ago."] I have asthma, and I

have very vivid memories of having an asthma attack as a kid. So Ezra comes down with a cold, we come down with the cold, we're all there, miserable in bed, and suddenly he's really, really having a hard time breathing. So we're like, oh, this is pretty scary. We bring him to the doctor, our health fund's doctor, who prescribes a Ventolin nebuliser. Okay, great. We get that, we do it, and in the middle of the night we're like, this is not working, he's getting worse. You can see him pulling his neck. We're like, okay, I don't feel good just staying here.

So we call our health fund, Maccabi. Basically, the first time, when we went to Terem, I can't remember exactly; I don't think they answered. So by the time we got to urgent care… The helpline says it's not an emergency response.

The second time, which was more recently, was much, much worse. That was terrible. We went to this urgent care place, which I won't name. Same story, exactly the same pattern. They say his oxygen is a bit low and we need to give him oxygen. We go into the room and we're just left there for 20, 30 minutes. He throws up, nobody comes. There's no one working there. My wife and I are like, what do we do? Are we supposed to just wait here, like they told us? And he was refusing the oxygen; he wouldn't let us put it up to his face. So we went to the ER. They were great. And we met another family there who'd had exactly the same experience. They were like, yeah, we just don't go there anymore.

So the healthcare system, the vaunted healthcare system, which I appreciate is good in large areas: that's a problem.

Judicial reform, Netanyahu and the commission of inquiry (26:30)

So I read about judicial reform. I read about whether Netanyahu is suitable to stay in government because of the corruption allegations about a few cigars. Everyone says this, but there was a time when, if I said it, it wasn't with conviction. Now I can say it with conviction: I'm not a Netanyahu fan at all. I really believe… whatever, I don't think it's constructive. And that's my issue with Israeli politics: you can just say it's become obsessed with the minutiae of his rule and with these issues, the Haredi draft, the judicial reform. Before we create ten splinter parties and debate these grand issues in a country without a constitution…

Every single time I wonder how it is that we have a political system where, electoral cycle after electoral cycle, parties can stand up with essentially no coherent policy platform, no research-backed platform targeting the burning issues: OECD maths scores, there's a list of them. Instead it's: we're going to create a new party that's anti-Haredim; this one's pro-Haredim; this one's a mixture. And I think it's across the board.

It's accepted by the people who vote for these parties, and there's so much fractionalism and self-interest that they can't learn the lessons of the destruction of the left, and see that in their rush to create new splinter parties they're splitting the vote and harming the collective interest. But no one, including the voters… And the organisers say: the October 7th commission of inquiry, [unclear: "fault finding bring"].

Okay, that was horrific. It was a tragedy. It was horrible. Of course there should be a state commission of inquiry. But is that the most important thing? That's not a policy. "We're for a state commission of inquiry into October 7th" shouldn't be front-line policy. I see two potentially useful reasons for one. One, a security review: learn lessons and improve. That's a task for the security bodies. Two, culpability: there have to be punishments, and if that doesn't exist, there's a more fundamental issue. But an independent commission: I just don't understand what that is supposed to achieve or do for the benefit of this whole state and this whole country. It seems a very strange reaction to this horrible attack that it's going to eclipse everything else.

Because the Israel I see is tearing itself asunder. It's dog eat dog. Young people who move here, who make aliyah, can be kicked out of an apartment because there's a property boom and the landlord decides he wants to cash in, and they're on the pavement, and the state says, that's just the way it is. I feel those are more important issues; those fixes would be more widely beneficial than the results of any state inquiry into October 7th could be.

The parties, the bread and butter, and Israel's reputation (30:25)

So I find myself looking at one party after the other, the old ones, and the jaded pattern of ex-generals creating their own party, and I just see another iteration of the exact same problem. The rotten root: the total lack of a political system that views itself as being there to represent people. Big issues, policy related to security,

questions of national identity, need national consensus: a constitution and, in the tradition of democracy I grew up in, a referendum. Those big issues are of course important, and of course they're going to delineate between parties. But there is a complete and utter lack of focus on the bread and butter, to use that really trite analogy.

The Israel I'd like, personally, is an Israel where hard-working people can do well, can afford to have a good life here, can vacation in Israel without it being four times the cost of a cheap getaway in Europe. And then of course the national issues. Israel's reputation is in the gutter because of whatever this rotten system of government is that requires extremist racists like Ben-Gvir and Smotrich and the others to hold it together. It's hard to articulate, which is why I'm probably going to have to cut some audio at this part of the note. But I hope this explains what I care about personally.

What I want to see is an Israel that is strong, that forms alliances where possible. On the Palestinian question, I'll just say that I don't rule out a Palestinian state as a principle. I just don't see any way it can be done, and I don't think that's what's holding everything back.

I think Israel's reaction to October 7th has created enormous, and I think honestly largely justified, international rage and disgust, and the government has done nothing about it. All we do is fund more hasbara: let's fire off some more propaganda. And the world is tired of it. And Netanyahu, after telling us that Iran was being contained, like he did last summer, suddenly retweets an image of a bomb over Tel Aviv. What kind of integrity is that? What kind of leaders...? How low have we sunk from the days of wholesome people like Ben Gurion, that this is just what passes [unclear: "what passes other people in the Likud actually see it for that"], or people just laugh and say, well, that's just electioneering. But it's a dismal place to have sunk.

So I want an Israel run by thoughtful people. They don't have to be technocrats, but committed people furthering the collective good, peace and prosperity, and focusing on Israel for once. Everything seems to be externalised for some reason. That's what I've noticed: the global reputation is tanking and we're focused on building bridges with the Jewish diaspora.

National identity and the diaspora (34:24)

My long-term philosophy here, contrarian again, is that this should not be in scope. Israel fights the view that the Jewish people and Israel are different things, and I agree there's a portion of world Jewry who aren't Zionist. But if, on the other hand, you say we're appointing ourselves the global protector, representative and guardian of world Jews, you've just created that conflation, so you can't then turn around and say... I think it's unfair, frankly.

And I don't think that, in a country with the kind of healthcare that exists here, at least in parts, we should be doing that. Israel was founded in 1948. If Jewish communities abroad aren't interested in moving here, why should we maintain this apparatus? And these other big tranches of public waste: the efforts to combat antisemitism, the efforts at public diplomacy that never really show fruit and create this national obsession with how the world sees us, which is almost glaringly... I just don't think it serves any good. I think the best answer to antisemitism and anti-Israelism is to make Israel great. You can't [unclear: "criticism"]; you can't create a world where everyone likes you.

A political class asleep at the wheel (36:05)

We see so many good things here and also so many challenges. We've got a full caseload of stuff to work on in this country: building it up and making it what it should be. And we've got a waste-of-time political leadership, a political class that's asleep at the wheel. I think the economy and the country are driven by the talent and skill of everyone else, including the army for that matter, and the politicians are just what they are. We need a radically reformed political system, a radical improvement in transparency, and programmes for government that are coherent.

The meta thing is a move away from those issues. There'll always be issues for parties to argue about, the security situation, if that never changes. But if that's all we view, whether we're coming from the left or the right, as legitimate for a party to articulate policy about, then we'll never get past security. And that's what's happening.

The cottage cheese protest, the housing protest: that's ancient history in comparative terms now. Why has there been no movement since? Look at the numbers. The situation's not getting better, and yet we're all up in arms about judicial reform. Very dangerous, very erosive. But at least can we be consistent, in proportion to what's actually going to affect people? I think people [unclear: "be on the street for, for that didn't talk about"]: wealth inequality, intergenerational wealth differences in Israel. That's a huge issue.

And I think a lot of the political class's disconnect, and why they're so content arguing about anything but rent, is that most of the political class in Israel belong to old families who have a lot of property and, like many old Israeli families, have an investment stream that's being funded by newcomers. I just think it's such a perversion of the Zionist ideal. This was not the idea of a Jewish state where every Jewish person had a home and could have a dignified life here. I can't imagine this was anything like what Herzl intended.

So that's all I can get off my chest in these 40 minutes before the election.

The research task (38:45)

What I'd like from you, Claude: I'm part writer, part-time data nerd, so I'd like to do this systematically. Take that lump of thought I've provided and give some coherence to it. I've already created a dataset for the parties on Hugging Face: the lists, who's on each list. Let's do it like this. Let's define an objective rubric for judging the parties according to the issues I assign priority to and where I stand on those. Then let's review each party one by one, give it a score, and stratify the analysis by alignment.

Put security, the nation-state and Haredi enlistment to one side for the moment, and call those stream B issues. Stream A issues, what I'd call my socioeconomic and non-divisive issues, are the less contentious things I see as the everyday pain points facing Israeli citizens. I've given just a few examples: rent, housing instability, cost of living, bureaucracy. I'd actually put Israel's global reputation in that too, because on the one hand it's a meta issue, and on the other it's one that trickles down: everyone bears it in some way or another, I believe.

First, rank the parties from best match to lowest match on stream A alone; then on both axes, so split two is alignment on both together. Then give me an analysis with a summary of the parties' positions.

What I want from a party (40:26)

As one high-level guide to what I'm looking for, my [unclear: "David Fiducia"; possibly "ideal" or "dream"] party's mission statement would be: we're here not because we demand a commission of inquiry for October 7th, not because we say the Haredim must serve. That language, whether I agree with it or not, immediately alienates me, because it's the next version of the same story: the last ten elections, 2026 edition. Instead: we're here because we can see that the State of Israel… we're here… (I didn't even mention Iran, but put security in [unclear: "In Tron, whatever it was. Tron"].) And this is our programme. It's free, it's consultative, it's democratic. We welcome participation. We're here to serve you. This is how we think, and this is how we propose to do it. Cards on the table.

As for manifestations of that: the bar is so incredibly low that if a party had a PDF on its website for a certain area of policy, translated into all the commonly spoken languages in Israel, even that, I think, would be a hard bar to pass. But it would be a very favourable indication.

That's it. That's today's research task. And it's good that I recorded this, so it can go onto this notepad, my public journal: my thoughts on what I'm finding frustrating about the political cycle in Israel, and where we are as a country at the moment.

Corrections

Applied in both files unless marked "edited version only". Times are the start of the transcript paragraph containing the word.

- 00:00 "today is 28th October 2026" → "26th October 2026". This was Daniel's own slip, not a transcription error: recorded 2026-10-26, the day before the 27 October election.
- 00:58 "tipst" → "Typst" (the typesetting program).
- 01:26 "sometimes it's a recurrence space" → "sometimes it's recurring" (edited version only; interpretation).
- 02:14 "it's a forest" → "it's a farce".

- 03:14 “sugbet Knesset” → left as [unclear].
- 04:17 “we will not be in government was this party” → “with this party”.
- 06:48 “Eisenhower” → “Eisenkot” (Gadi Eisenkot).
- 08:21 (said at about 08:50) “we told that Andrew” → “we told the landlord”. Likely mishearing; flagged, not confirmed.
- 08:56 “I couldn’t believe state the apart” → left as [unclear] (edited version only; the disfluencies-removed file keeps the wording).
- 13:31 “shekeels” → “shekels”.
- 16:12 “miley” → “mildly”.
- 16:35 “an endless creation” → left as [unclear], possibly “construction” (edited version only).
- 16:49 “digging up that right and center” → “left, right and center”. Inferred from context.
- 16:49 “post a road change” → left as [unclear].
- 22:31 “Betsal El Smotrich” → “Bezalel Smotrich”.
- 22:46 “seeing as ready flags” → “seeing Israeli flags”. Inferred from context.
- 23:19 “gratitious” → “gratuitous”.
- 23:19 Of the US: “a basic level of dysfunction” → “a basic level of function” (edited version only). Daniel clearly means function there; the disfluencies-removed file keeps “dysfunction” as he said it.
- 24:17 “Our son just started. His began well a couple of months ago.” → left as [unclear] (edited version only).
- 25:10 “the first time we went to terror” → “Terem” (the Jerusalem urgent-care chain).
- 27:33 “heradium” / “her radium” → “Haredim”.
- 28:18 “fault finding bring” → left as [unclear] (edited version only).
- 29:18 “the Israel icy” → “the Israel I see”.
- 29:18 (said at about 30:05) “the stake and say” → “the state and say”.
- 31:17 “Ben Ver” → “Ben-Gvir”.
- 33:25 “a dismal place to have song” → “sunk”.
- 33:25 “I want in Israel where” → “I want an Israel where”.
- 33:25 “this is just what passes other people in the Likud actually see it for that” → partly left as [unclear] (edited version only).
- 34:24 “world jury” → “world Jewry”.
- 34:24 “created that inflation” → “conflation”.
- 34:24 “the Jewish people in Israel are different things” → “the Jewish people and Israel are different things”. Inferred from context.
- 34:56 “you can’t criticism” → left as [unclear] (edited version only).
- 37:20 “why is there, we know movement since” → “no movement since”.
- 37:48 “people be on the street for, for that didn’t talk about” → left as [unclear] (edited version only).
- 40:26 “Haredian” → “Haredim”.
- 40:26 “my David Fiducia party” → left as [unclear], possibly “my ideal/dream party”.
- 41:25 “In. In Tron, whatever it was. Tron” → left as [unclear].
- Confirmed correct as transcribed: Maccabi, Arnona, hasbara, aliyah, Herzl, Ben Gurion, OECD, AliExpress, Times of Israel.

ASSEMBLYAI OUTPUT, UNEDITED

Raw transcript

Transcript id c2ba33df-42da-45d1-8946-c62f9a74e51b. It includes the spoken date slip (“28th October”) and the mishearings listed under Corrections in the edited transcript.

Okay, so today is 28th October 2026, the day before the elections in Israel. And I, like many people in Israel, feel very disillusioned, disenfranchised with the entire political system. But I turn to you Claude, in order to create a guide tailored to my own voting what I'm looking for in a party, as it were. So I'll set out in this voice note which will be in a public repository. The which is intentional, in case you're asking.

So we'll do our usual process of sending this for. Sending this audio file for transcription, then getting a cleaned up version and please keep the audio file, the binary in the. In the repo and just link to it in the readme in case anyone wants to actually hear the original for chain of custody. This is just if. No, can't think of any reason why.

But it's a demonstration, I guess, of a voice to research workflow that I do a lot in which I'll use a voice note to record a lengthy research brief and get all the details in and then I'll send Claude off to do his Claude like thing. And then usually I'll try. I'll. I'll pair that with some kind of an output skill which I typically tend to use tipst. I keep thinking I'm pronouncing it wrong.

The typesetting program, which is just fantastic tool. So I'll usually then round out the skill by saying, Claude, summarize your research in a PDF, bake it into a PDF, put it to my Google Drive, send it to me by email. And that's kind of the life cycle of a research repository. Sometimes once off, sometimes it's a recurrence space. So this one is just a public, public demo and sometimes I'll generate a podcast from it.

So this one, I might also create a podcast episode too, as sometimes I prefer to listen to what Claude finds and. Or both. They're complementary. Okay, so here is the. Here is basically my feelings on the current state of affairs in Israel.

So my long standing critique of Israeli politics is. And I'm recording this actually looking at the Israeli Parliament building from outside of a window here. Not metaphorically speaking, literally. I can see it from where I'm recording this and when I look upon it, I feel this feeling of disgust that rises from an institution that has become so far divorced from any mandate of serving citizens, that it's unimaginable that this, this house is a, it's a forest, it's not representing the interests of Israeli, the Israeli Electorate. It's a, it's a collection of self important people infighting, people abusing the name of the Knesset, the institution in, in ancient Israel and some of the manifestations of it, the 120 seats and it's a slight on the old institution.

It's a, it's a Knesset of, it's a sugbet Knesset, whatever you want to call it.

And you know, the, in the litany of things that I feel is broken and wrong with Israeli politics, I feel it stems from one very fundamental. There's one rotten root to it which is that in the way this country is set up, our electoral system here there is no accountability baked into the system and we have an electorate that accepts this because this is the way things are here and Israelis are at once. Is my external critique as someone who moved here from, from Ireland at once very worldly and sometimes also peculiar. Peculiarly, peculiarly. I'm having a hard time with some words today in a peculiar way insular in the sense that, you know, this is their frame of reference and this is how politics are done here.

And my frame of reference, having grown up in Ireland, which has, you know, its own pros and cons about its political system, but at least one of the good things you can say about it is that because you have a politician you vote for at the national elections for an electoral area and there is theoretically someone you can complain to or you know, contact to get, to get representation and we have this completely broken political system here in which there is, because of the design of the, of the political system, we have incentivized an extremely fractured and divisive political system that is characterized by repetitive breakaway alliances that are splitting votes and which are often less often created in order to, you know, create genuinely interesting ideological propositions and coherent platforms and more often because some person didn't get the, the slate that they thought that was becoming to them and therefore they decided I'm going to form a breakaway party or the party exists because one of its core principles is we will not be in government was this

party. And the commonality here is that none of these expressions articulate anything about what, what this party is going to do for the electorate or the people. That's the fundamental problem as I see it, with Israeli politics. So, you know, I've been kind of reading naturally about who's running in this upcoming election and trying to even summon up the, the motivation to do that because it's exhausting. What there's like three more political parties, four more, five More from the last time.

Why? Who? And the first question you'd ask about any of them is, well, what do they stand for that's going to actually benefit my life. And all you read about in the news has nothing to do with that. The political system that we have here in Israel creates because the Israeli electorate is itself so divided in this system.

The only way to. The way which, the way in which parties differentiate themselves is by differentiating upon the slice of the electorate that they pander to instead of collective issues. And the reason I feel so profoundly disillusioned about the political situation in Israel is that, you know, I could say, okay, well, hopefully Netanyahu will not be elected. That's the one person I'm for sure not voting for. When people say, well, what about Eisenhower, what about this party, that party?

I say, it's the same problem. That's what. That's where, you know, I will be even more pessimistic than some people here because I'll say, yeah, it's more of the same. Can't you see that there parties who are saying we were, we will, we demand that the Haredim draft exemption will end the judicial reform and the issues that matter to me in my 10 years living in the state of Israel as an immigrant who moved here from Ireland, by the greatest detrimental thing or the biggest issue in my life, and it's not even close, is an issue that last time I checked, not a single major party running in this election had bothered to articulate any serious policy for. And that is tenant protection law.

I spent the majority of June, July, it's all a blur this summer, basically self moving an apartment. And we did that because our previous landlord, we had a leak, woke up one day to find that there was water dripping on my bed. And when I asked after two weeks, you know, we told that Andrew on the day when I said, so are you gonna fix it? He came the next day and then sent us this. You know, it was very pleasant.

Of course I'm gonna get a fix. I'm gonna get right on it. And then followed up the next day with an extremely angry, I couldn't believe state the apart and basically retaliatory termination of the lease. And we had, you know, our son is now 15 months old. the time was much younger.

We were sleeping as a family on the couch because our room, I mean, it got to the point where there was mold growing on the, on the roof. I was sending the landlord video updates being like, for your sake, not mine, you probably want to like, get on this asap because your. Your place is being ruined. You know, I got. Literally did everything in my power to.

To make it happen. And it's a. It's a. It's something that the law says they have three days to do it. And of course, he just didn't do it, because what's the point of having a law if there is absolutely no consequence to it?

And if people. What's the point of having a law if people are. If. The lesson that. The chilling effect of my story that reverberates out through our friends and through my colleagues and the rest is that don't dare exercise even the minimal laws you.

The rights you have, because the landlord will just decide not to renew your lease. And because we have tenancy at will, he can say, yeah, I just decided not to. You know, even though this was a very clear example of a retaliatory lease, it made absolutely no difference. And we found this turned into a. But this.

This is the hot issue that gets me hot under the collar. We consulted with a lawyer, and he was very unpleasant. We couldn't fix. We. We asked to.

Even we. We were like, trying to explain to the man that we need. He's like, yeah, just okay, if you don't want to stay here, just leave. And we're like, okay, but, like, you do realize that we need a roof over our heads. Like, I don't know if that point was like, lost in translation there, Mr. Landlord.

So when we went to our lawyer, we kind of got the same reaction. And we're both like, my wife and I, okay, we're just going to tell you what finding a place to live in Jerusalem is like at the moment. It means you go for viewings after viewing, after viewing, you have to play. You have to firstly pay an illegal agency. Because every single agent has cornered the market in basically a scam that frustrated the previous attempt at creating tenancy law.

It's an illegal thing that they found this ridiculous workaround for, and de facto you have to pay it. That's one month's rent plus VAT to the agent fee. So when you find a new place, if you find a new place, you're looking at your weekend spent trudging around with a. With a young baby. Neither of us have family in Israel.

Going in, you know, in the heat of the summer to see the depressing places. We even found that some of the listings, this was. This was the. This was the. The kind of pinnacle of it.

They began new trends, started saying this image on listings you'd see, like, image was enhanced with artificial intelligence. So you're like, wait, okay, so this is like an AI image of the place that you're posting. And the last move was astronomically expensive. You have to disconnect all the utilities from the landlord's name because the local municipality in Jerusalem, in all its infinite wisdom, which it's, you know, with which it exerts itself digging up the city and making this place chaos, has not actually come up with any workable system for tenants to pay their Arnona, the highest one in the country, in a way that doesn't incur a yearly obligation to them on a property they don't own. So you have to literally do unpaid admin work for the landlord to get yourself and also to get yourself off the hook for paying somebody else's municipal bill plus electricity, plus water, plus the rest of it.

Then in the next place, you've the pleasure of doing all of this again. So the last time we moved, similar story. This landlord was a lot nicer, but we lost the place after paying rent every single month on time. The rest of it, because he wanted to give his apartment away to his daughters. So I can't even describe, like, the cumulative, the mental sense of like.

Like loss of stability. A deep, a profound sort of like when you don't feel like you have a place and we're working, we're putting, we're saving. Where my wife's an architect, I work in tech, and we're looking at the spreadsheets and we're like, A, it doesn't really matter because the numbers just don't seem to check out that we can do this. And B, even if it did, even if we were doing everything in our power to get on the property ladder and the rest of it and living off beans and rice, I don't think we'd have anything to show for it because every time we do this, like, the Last move was 10,000 shekels. The next move was 10,000 shekeels time off work.

This one, I literally moved half our boxes ourselves. So if you're listening, if anyone ever listens to this or reads a transcript and you're hearing a man rant for 10 minutes about how I spent my summer trying to parent a toddler while moving boxes to do as much of the move as I could, because between all these expenses and deposits and agent fees, we literally, to ensure cash flow, had to have a cheap move. That's when I look around and say, how is the state? This is. This is Just like that's the biggest setback to.

For me, the Jewish vision of every Jewish person moving to Israel and having a place to live here and prospering. I'm like, yeah, but like we.

The cost of living and the rest of it is such that getting on their property ladder is near impossible.

I can't. If I had literally, if my hourly rate were multiplied by the amount of hours that I spent tearing up ethernet cables in a previous rental, but to put them back down in the next one, packing boxes, unpacking boxes, moving boxes, finding, finding place for things, starting unboxing. Like to do that with a family, I would be. My bank account would be in a much better state than it was now. Put it like that.

So that's been. Mentally, spiritually, personally. The drain that is like sucked so much of what's good about this country and turned it into frustration and anger and cynicism. It's that other things, honestly, not so much. I actually enjoy living here.

The people are great. I love the food. You know, I adapt to the culture. The tech is amazing. There's so much that's good here.

The bad thing, you know, religious extremism, I find in Jerusalem, I don't like that it's becoming coercive. I'm not a fan of Jerusalem, to put it miley these days at least. Or I'm very. Let's say I'm less optimistic about the city than I ever have been or more pessimistic. But that issue as well is just.

It's like a case study in how to mismanage a city. What's happening at the moment, an endless creation. It's sheer greed. It's absolutely. It's catastrophic.

It's. The city is basically just digging up that right and center to create this enormous glut of high rises, turning a blind eye to the fact that half of them are just for investment properties or people who won't live here, while people actually living in the city are literally watching these out of place big skyscrapers going up that they won't be able to afford to live in. And no one's even bothering to post a road change. And we're like, this city is like a joke. Like, seriously, like, who.

Who's actually. You read about the. The cable car going to the old city. You're like, that was the front news today on the Times of Israel. And you're like, who's calling the shots in this place?

Because they do not have their heads screwed on. The city needs the poorest city in Israel, this place needs jobs, incentives for creating jobs. We don't need luxury housing, crazy investment properties. We need coherent, accessible, affordable housing. And, and you can't just plonk people in housing without creating at least some basic scaffolding for an economy here.

And you look at the resources the city puts into that and it's atrocious, it's minimal. I don't blame any VC or investor from, you know, from not really being so hot on the Jerusalem pitch. A city best known these days for religious extremism and riots and. Yeah, no, I don't like anyway, so that, that despite all that negativity, I think Jerusalem is the capital of the Jewish world and the city deserves so much better than this and should be such a more inclusive, affordable and accessible place in this. And I use all those adjectives together.

So the anger comes from my feeling that this is just a microcosm of what's gone wrong in this country, that something nice about it. The good things about the city, about Jerusalem, the slower pace of life compared to Tel Aviv, the fact that people are a bit, you know, less maybe so stylish. I like that. I really like that. Actually, I'm not a, you know, I'm not a very ostentatious person.

But when that gets, what's happening now, the stagnation of the long term residents in the city center and this artificial glut of construction for people who will parachute in here for a few weeks a year, don't speak Hebrew, don't want to interact with people like what kind of a recipe for coherence in a city, in a capital city is that? It's a disaster. So where was I? Where should I pick up this rant?

So when I look at the, what everyone's jockeying over, do I think that the haredim, the ultra religious, should serve in the army? Yes.

I think the social contract can't exist like this. You can't have an internal state within a state. You have to have some basic commonality within the state that the rule of law is the rule of law and you don't get benefits if you don't contribute. So many people, I can say from our own experience as well, there's no. If you're a struggling young family working and being beaten down by agent fees and slumlords and all the stuff we can talk about from personal experience ad nauseam, there is essentially no help.

When the war with Iran broke out, I feel like the. I just, I was kind of in disbelief. That was long. That was A long war. The one earlier this year was it five weeks.

And you know, you wake up one day, a siren goes off at three in the morning or whatever, whatever time it started. And you're like, oh, oh crap. Like what's going on? And then I'm kind of a prepper or have become a prepper. You're like, well, everything's planned, right?

Like the shelters are open and they're not. And at the time, in our old place, like many buildings, we did not have a public shelter. And it's a litany of like, there's no map, there's no interactive map. When war broke out, they weren't open.

I contributed a router to a shelter that got stolen. We got a. It's a parking ticket after the last war. That was crazy. After the ceasefire, the shelter was a car park, literally.

City run shelter was the designated. Sorry, city run car park was a designated shelter, deep shelter. And ceasefire was announced and we were charged for like I think an hour or two of parking, exit fee. And you're like, what? For sheltering an emergency?

Like, are you serious? So it's just things like this. I'm like, what has this state become? Like, how did, how did we go from

this collectivist, idealistic poor, but like wholesome society to this thing? Because like this is not a.

You know what I mean? Like these dynamics are just like, they're, they're bigger than any one thing. These are just the little things that I notice. But so okay, to be more, to be more coherent. Like what, what things affect me in my personal life day to day.

The cost of living. No one seems to be doing anything about it. Like the fact that they had this tax exemption for AliExpress. How petty can you be? Everything here is overpriced.

It's always been overpriced. The competition, it's anti competitive. And some guy, Betsal El Smotrich, the right wing guy, introduces like raises the limit and they put it back. You're like, what a miserable government. This is literally like, come on.

Like that, that's how. That's the AliExpress is the escape valve for the Israeli economy. I'm convinced. It's like you realize everyone is buying. Go on to AliExpress listing in any listing and you're like, you're like seeing as ready flags.

You're like, wait, is this like everyone buying everything from this? And you ask your friends and you're like, oh yeah, that's so like we're all doing this because everything here, it costs like Double or triple what it does abroad. And like, it's. And there's no warranty. Or when you try to get your warranty, there's no warranty service.

Like, it's all this just. It's all this dysfunctionalism. When I go to the US or visit the US with my in laws, I appreciate that they have, you know, so many internal divisions and debates in the us but the biggest thing that's like a breath of fresh air when I visit the US Is the feeling that there is a basic level of dysfunction. There's a basic level of dysfunction here that just feels like, gratitious. You're like, it does not need to be this way.

Like life does. Like, you're. It's like you're trying to make life hard. It's like the delivery driver who, who gets irate. A bad example.

But whether it's the bureaucracy for small business, it just feels like it's like when that layer is removed, you're like, oh, well, stuff, actually. Oh, this is pretty nice. Other things I noticed recently. So our son, we had to go to ER twice in the course of the last month. We had a pretty rough month.

Our son just started. His began well a couple of months ago. So I have asthma, and I have very vivid memories of having an asthma attack as a kid. So Ezra comes down with the cold. We come down with the cold.

We're all there, miserable in bed, and suddenly he's really, really having a hard time breathing, right? So we're like, oh, this is pretty scary. We bring him to the doctor. The doctor says, this is our health fund. Prescribes Ventolin nebulizer.

We're like, okay, great. So we get that, we do it. And in middle of the night, we're like, this is not working. He's getting worse. Like, you can see, like, his neck.

He's like pulling his neck. We're like, okay, this is like, we. I don't feel good. Just like staying here. So we call our health fund Maccabi.

And basically, I can't remember the first time we went to terror. Like, I don't think they answered. So by the time we got to urgent care, there's no, like, the helpline says it's not emergency response.

And the second time, which was more recently, was just much, much. That was terrible. So we went there to this urgent care place, which I. I won't name, which. Same story, same pattern exactly. And they say, his oxygen is a bit low.

We need to give him oxygen. We go into the room and we're just left there 20, 30 minutes, he throws up, nobody comes. And we're like trying to, there's no one working there. And my wife and I are like, what do we do? It's like supposed to just like wait here, like they've just told us.

And he was refusing oxygen, like he wouldn't, he wouldn't put it up to his, you know, his face. So we went to the er. They were great. And we met another family there who had the exact same situation. They were like, yeah, we just don't go there anymore.

So the healthcare system, the vaunted healthcare system, which I appreciate in large areas is good, that's a problem. So I read about judicial reform. I read about whether Netanyahu is suitable to stay in government because of the corruption allegations about a few cigars. And I say the first thing sometimes, you know, this is, everyone says this, but there was a time, if I said this before, it wasn't with conviction. Now I can say with conviction.

I'm not a Netanyahu fan at all. I really believe he's, I think, like, whatever, I don't think it's constructive. And that's my issue with Israeli politics. You can, you can just say it's become obsessed with the minutiae of his rule and these issues about the haredim draft, the judicial reform.

Before we create 10 splinter parties and we debate these grand issues in a country without a constitution.

I just wonder every single time how is it that we have a political system whereby electoral cycle after electoral cycle, parties can basically stand up with essentially no platform, coherent platform policy, platform research backed platform targeting the burning issues, OECD math scores. I mean, there's a list of them. And instead we, we see it as like, well, we're going to create a new party that's going to be anti heradium. This one's going to be like pro her radium. This one's going to be a mixture.

And, and I think it's, it's across the board.

The fact that it's accepted by the people who will vote for these parties and that there's so much fractionalism and self interest that they can't learn the lessons of what happened to the destruction of the left and see that in their rush to create new splinter parties, they're splitting the vote and harming the collective interest. But no one, including the voters. And the organizers say, like the October 7th Commission of Inquiry fault finding bring. Okay, I mean that, that was horrific. It was a tragedy.

It was horrible. Of course there should be a State commission of inquiry. But is that, is that the, is that the most important? That's not a policy. That shouldn't be frontline policy.

We're for state commission of inquiry into October 7th. That's a security, I mean two potentially I think useful reasons for that. One, security review, improve, learn lessons and improve. That's a task for the security bodies. Two, culpability.

So there has to be punishments. And if that can, if that doesn't exist, then there's a more fundamental issue. But an independent commission, I just don't understand what that is supposed to achieve or do for the benefit of this whole state and this whole country. It seems like a very strange reaction to this horrible attack that this is going to eclipse everything else because the Israel icy that's tearing itself asunder, that's dog eat dog where people, young people who, who move here, you know, make aliyah to come to Israel can be kicked out of a apartment because there's a property boom and the landlord decides he wants to cash in and they're on the, on the, on the pavement and the stake and say there's. That's, that's just the way it is.

I feel like those are more important issues that, like those, those fixes would be more widely beneficial than any. The, the results of any state inquiry into October 7th could be. So I find myself looking at the one party after the other, the old ones and the jaded pattern of ex generals and I just see, you know, creating their own party, just see another iteration of the exact same problem. The, the root, the, the rotten root, the total lack of, the lack of a political system that views the electorate is there to represent people that big issues, policy related to security, questions of national identity need national consensus in a constitution and in the tradition of democracy I grew up in, a referendum. Those can be those big issues, of course important and they are of course going to delineate between parties.

But there is a complete and utter lack of focus on the bread and butter, to use that really, you know, trite analogy. And the Israel that I like personally is an Israel where hard working people can do well, can afford to have a good life here to vacation in Israel without it being, you know, four times the cost of a cheap getaway in Europe. And of course the, the national issues. Israel's reputation is in the gutter because we have a, whatever, whatever this rotten system of government is that requires a extremist racist like Ben Ver and Smotrich and the others to hold this together.

Like it's just it's, it's hard to articulate, which is why I'm probably gonna have to cut some audio here at this part of the note. But I hope this explains where I feel what I care about personally. You know, what I want to see is a, is an Israel that is strong, that forms alliances where possible.

The Palestinian question, I, I will just say that I, I don't rule out a Palestinian state as a principle. I just don't see any

way that it can be done and any, I don't think that's what's holding everything back.

I think that Israel's reaction to October 7th has created enormous and I think honestly largely justified international rage and disgust and the government has done nothing to. All we do is just fund more hasbara. Let's, let's, let's fire some more propaganda. And the world is, the world is like tired of it. And Netanyahu comes out with, after telling us that Iran's being contained like he did last summer, suddenly retweeting an image of a bomb over Tel Aviv.

So we're like what kind of integrity is that? What kind of, what kind of leaders like how low have we sunk from the days of wholesome people like Ben Gurion that this is, this is just what passes other people in the Likud actually see it for that or just kind of laugh and say well that's just electioneering but it's a dismal, it's a dismal place to have song. So I want in Israel where the people who thoughtful people not doesn't have to be technocrats but committed people furthering their collective good, peace and prosperity and focusing on Israel for once. Everything seems to be externalized for some reason. That's what I've noticed where the world, the global reputation is tanking and we're focused on building bridges with the Jewish Diaspora.

My long term term philosophy here, contrarian again is that should not be in scope. If Israel's fighting the view that the, that the Jewish people in Israel are different things. And I, I agree there's a, there's a portion of world jury who aren't Zionist then if you say on the other hand, well we're appointing ourselves the global protector and represent and guardian of world Jews. You've just created that inflation so you can't then turn around and say you've. I think it's unfair frankly.

And I don't think in a country with the kind of health care that exists at least in parts here, we should be doing that. You know, Israel was founded in 1948. If Jewish communities abroad aren't interested in moving here, I would say why, why, why should we maintain this apparatus for these other big tranches of public waste, the efforts to combat anti Semitism, the efforts for public diplomacy that never really show fruit and create this national obsession with how the world sees us that is kind of almost glaringly, I just don't think serves any, any good. I think the best answer to anti Semitism and anti Israelism is to make Israel great. And I don't believe that everything, you can't, you can't criticism, you can't, you know, you can't create a world where everyone likes you.

And we've just see so many, so many good things here and also so many challenges I think are we've got a full caseload of stuff to work on in this country and building up this country and making this country what it should be. And we've got basically a waste of time, political leadership, political class that's asleep at the wheel. I think the economy and country is driven by the talent and, and, and skill of, of everyone else, including the army for that matter. And I think the politicians are just what they are. And we need a radically, radically reformed political system, radical improvement in transparency, programs for government that are coherent.

And the meta thing is a move away from issues of. Because there'll always be these issues for people to, for parties to argue about the political, the security situation, if that never changes. But that's all we, that's all we view as whether we're coming from the left or the right, that that's what it's legitimate for a party to articulate policy about. Then we'll never get past security. And that's what's happening.

You know, the cottage cheese protest, the housing protest. That's ancient history in comparative terms now why is there, we know movement since look at, look at the numbers. Situation's not getting better and yet we're all up in arms about judicial reform. Very, very dangerous, very erosive. But at least can we be consistent with the stuff we actually, you know, if it was in proportion to what it's actually going to affect people.

I think people be on the street for, for that didn't talk about wealth inequality, intergenerational wealth differences in Israel. That's a huge issue. And I think a lot of it, a lot of the disconnect from the political class and why they're so content arguing about anything but rent is that most of the political class in Israel belong to old Families who have a lot of property and like many old Israeli families have an investment stream of that's being funded by newcomers and I just think it's such a. It's such a perversion of the Zionist idealist. This was not, this was not how the idea of a Jewish state where every Jewish person had a home and it could have a dignified life here, this was not.

I can't imagine that this was anything like what Herzl intended. So that's who I. That's all I can get off my chest in these 40 minutes before the election. And what I look what I like from you Claude, is I am part writer, part data, part time, part time data nerd. So I'd like to do this systematically.

You can take that lump of thought that I provided and give some coherence to it. And then I'd like to I've already

created a data set for the parties on Hugging Face the lists, who's on the list and I'd like you to give me a. Let's do it like this. Let's define a objective rubric for judging the parties according to the issues that I assign priority to and where I stand on those. Then one by one let's review each party, let's give them a score and then let's stratify this analysis based upon alignment with what I would call my socioeconomic and non divisive I mean none not let's put security nation states, haredi enlistment, let's put those in to one side for the moment let's call that stream B issues and stream A issues are the less contentious things I see as the everyday pain points facing Israeli citizens and I've given just a few examples rent, housing instability, cost of living, bureaucracy and and I would actually put in Israel's global reputation in that because on the one hand it's a meta issue, on the other it's one that trickles.

Everyone bears that in some way or another I believe.

Let's call those A and I'd like to firstly rank the parties from most best match to lowest match just on that axis and then on both axis so split 2 will be alignment together and then you can give me a analysis with your with the summary of the of the party's positions and I will say as one meta guide, one high level guide to what I'm looking for is really my David Fiducia party the mission we're here not because we demand a commission of inquiry for October 7th because we say the Haredian must serve that language, whether I agree with it or not, immediately alienates me because I say it's the same next version of the same story. The last 10 elections, 2026 edition. We're here because we've. We can see that the state of Israel. We're here.

I didn't even mention Iran, but put security in, In. In Tron, whatever it was. Tron. And this is our program. It's free, it's consultative, it's democratic.

We welcome participation. We're here to serve you. And this is how we think. This is how we propose to do it.

Cards on the table. I mean, you know, manifestations of that, literally, the bar is. The bar is so incredibly low that you're like, well, if they had a PDF on their website for a certain area policy translated into all commonly spoken languages in Israel, even I think that would be a hard bar to pass. But that would be a. That would be a very favorable indication.

That's it. That's today's research task. And maybe good, I recorded that so I can get my public journal about my thoughts on what's. What I'm finding, you know, frustrating about the political cycle in Israel and just where we are as a country at the moment. Onto this notepad.